Hebrews

Chapters

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13

THE LETTER TO THE HEBREWS

God Has Spoken by His Son

1 In many and various ways God spoke of old to our fathers by the
prophets; **2**but in these last days he has spoken to us by a Son, whom he
appointed the heir of all things, through whom also he created the ages. **3**He
reflects the glory of God and bears the very stamp of his nature, upholding
the universe by his word of power. When he had made purification for sins,
he sat down at the right hand of the Majesty on high, **4**having become as
much superior to angels as the name he has obtained is more excellent than
theirs. *

The Son's Superiority to Angels

5 For to what angel did God ever say,
"You are my Son,
today I have begotten you"?
Or again,
"I will be to him a father,
and he shall be to me a son"?
6 And again, when he brings the first-born into the world, he says,
"Let all God's angels worship him."
7 Of the angels he says,
"Who makes his angels winds,
and his servants flames of fire."
8 But of the Son he says,
"Your throne, O God,[a] is for ever and ever,
the righteous scepter is the scepter of your[b] kingdom.
9 You have loved righteousness and hated lawlessness;
therefore God, your God, has anointed you
with the oil of gladness beyond your comrades."
10 And,
"You, Lord, founded the earth in the beginning,
and the heavens are the work of your hands;
11 they will perish, but you remain;
they will all grow old like a garment,
12 like a cloak you will roll them up,

and they will be changed.[c]
But you are the same,
and your years will never end.”
[13]But to what angel has he ever said,
“Sit at my right hand,
till I make your enemies
a stool for your feet”?
[14]Are they not all ministering spirits sent forth to serve, for the sake of those who are to obtain salvation?

Warning to Pay Attention

2 Therefore we must pay the closer attention to what we have heard, lest we drift away from it. [2]For if the message declared by angels * was valid and every transgression or disobedience received a just retribution, [3]how shall we escape if we neglect such a great salvation? It was declared at first by the Lord, and it was attested to us by those who heard him, [4]while God also bore witness by signs and wonders and various miracles and by gifts of the Holy Spirit distributed according to his own will.

Exaltation through Suffering

5 For it was not to angels that God subjected the world to come, of which we are speaking. [6]It has been testified somewhere,
“What is man that you are mindful of him,
or the son of man, that you care for him?
[7]You made him for a little while lower than the angels,
you have crowned him with glory and honor,[d]
[8]putting everything in subjection under his feet.”
Now in putting everything in subjection to him, he left nothing outside his control. As it is, we do not yet see everything in subjection to him. [9]But we see Jesus, who for a little while was made lower than the angels, crowned with glory and honor because of the suffering of death, so that by the grace of God he might taste death for every one.
10 For it was fitting that he, for whom and by whom all things exist, in bringing many sons to glory, should make the pioneer of their salvation perfect through suffering. * [11]For he who sanctifies and those who are sanctified have all one origin. That is why he is not ashamed to call them brethren, [12]saying,

"I will proclaim your name to my brethren,
in the midst of the congregation I will praise you."
13 And again,
"I will put my trust in him."
And again,
"Here am I, and the children God has given me."
14 Since therefore the children share in flesh and blood, he himself likewise partook of the same nature, that through death he might destroy him who has the power of death, that is, the devil, 15 and deliver all those who through fear of death were subject to lifelong bondage. 16 For surely it is not with angels that he is concerned but with the descendants of Abraham. 17 Therefore he had to be made like his brethren in every respect, so that he might become a merciful and faithful high priest in the service of God, to make expiation for the sins of the people. 18 For because he himself has suffered and been tempted, he is able to help those who are tempted.

Moses a Servant, Christ a Son

3 Therefore, holy brethren, who share in a heavenly call, consider Jesus, the apostle and high priest of our confession. 2 He was faithful to him who appointed him, just as Moses also was faithful in[e] God's house. 3 Yet Jesus has been counted worthy of as much more glory than Moses as the builder of a house has more honor than the house. 4 (For every house is built by some one, but the builder of all things is God.) 5 Now Moses was faithful in all God's house as a servant, to testify to the things that were to be spoken later, 6 but Christ was faithful over God's[f] house as a son. And we are his house if we hold fast our confidence and pride in our hope.[g]

Warning against Unbelief

7 Therefore, as the Holy Spirit says,
"Today, when you hear his voice,
8 do not harden your hearts as in the rebellion,
on the day of testing in the wilderness,
9 where your fathers put me to the test
and saw my works for forty years.
10 Therefore I was provoked with that generation,
and said, 'They always go astray in their hearts;
they have not known my ways.'

11 As I swore in my wrath,
‘They shall never enter my rest.' " *
12 Take care, brethren, lest there be in any of you an evil, unbelieving
heart, leading you to fall away from the living God. 13 But exhort one
another every day, as long as it is called “today,” that none of you may be
hardened by the deceitfulness of sin. 14 For we share in Christ, if only we
hold our first confidence firm to the end, 15 while it is said,
“Today, when you hear his voice,
do not harden your hearts as in the rebellion.”
16 Who were they that heard and yet were rebellious? Was it not all those
who left Egypt under the leadership of Moses? 17 And with whom was he
provoked forty years? Was it not with those who sinned, whose bodies fell
in the wilderness? 18 And to whom did he swear that they should never enter
his rest, but to those who were disobedient? 19 So we see that they were
unable to enter because of unbelief.

The Rest That God Promised

4 Therefore, while the promise of entering his rest remains, let us fear
lest any of you be judged to have failed to reach it. 2 For good news came to
us just as to them; but the message which they heard did not benefit them,
because it did not meet with faith in the hearers.[h] 3 For we who have
believed enter that rest, as he has said,
“As I swore in my wrath,
‘They shall never enter my rest,' "
although his works were finished from the foundation of the world. 4 For
he has somewhere spoken of the seventh day in this way, “And God rested
on the seventh day from all his works.” 5 And again in this place he said,
“They shall never enter my rest.”
6 Since therefore it remains for some to enter it, and those who formerly
received the good news failed to enter because of disobedience, 7 again he
sets a certain day, “Today,” saying through David so long afterward, in the
words already quoted,
“Today, when you hear his voice,
do not harden your hearts.”

8 For if Joshua had given them rest, God[i] would not speak later of another
day. 9 So then, there remains a sabbath rest for the people of God; 10 for
whoever enters God's rest also ceases from his labors as God did from his.
11 Let us therefore strive to enter that rest, that no one fall by the same
sort of disobedience. 12 For the word of God is living and active, sharper
than any two-edged sword, piercing to the division of soul and spirit, of
joints and marrow, and discerning the thoughts and intentions of the heart.
13 And before him no creature is hidden, but all are open and laid bare to the
eyes of him with whom we have to do.

Jesus the Great High Priest

14 Since then we have a great high priest who has passed through the
heavens, Jesus, the Son of God, let us hold fast our confession. 15 For we
have not a high priest who is unable to sympathize with our weaknesses,
but one who in every respect has been tempted as we are, yet without
sinning. 16 Let us then with confidence draw near to the throne of grace, that
we may receive mercy and find grace to help in time of need.

5 For every high priest chosen from among men is appointed to act on
behalf of men in relation to God, to offer gifts and sacrifices for sins. 2 He
can deal gently with the ignorant and wayward, since he himself is beset
with weakness. 3 Because of this he is bound to offer sacrifice for his own
sins as well as for those of the people. 4 And one does not take the honor
upon himself, but he is called by God, just as Aaron was.
5 So also Christ did not exalt himself to be made a high priest, but was
appointed by him who said to him,

"You are my Son,
today I have begotten you"; *
6 as he says also in another place,
"You are a priest for ever,
according to the order of Melchiz'edek."

7 In the days of his flesh, Jesus[j] offered up prayers and supplications, with
loud cries and tears, to him who was able to save him from death, and he
was heard for his godly fear. 8 Although he was a Son, he learned obedience
through what he suffered; 9 and being made perfect he became the source of
eternal salvation to all who obey him, 10 being designated by God a high
priest according to the order of Melchiz'edek.

Spiritual Growth

11 About this we have much to say which is hard to explain, since you
have become dull of hearing. **12**For though by this time you ought to be
teachers, you need some one to teach you again the first principles of God's
word. You need milk, not solid food; **13**for every one who lives on milk is
unskilled in the word of righteousness, for he is a child. **14**But solid food is
for the mature, for those who have their faculties trained by practice to
distinguish good from evil.

The Peril of Falling Away

6 Therefore let us leave the elementary doctrines of Christ and go on to
maturity, not laying again a foundation of repentance from dead works and
of faith toward God, **2**with instruction[k] about baptisms, the laying on of
hands, the resurrection of the dead, and eternal judgment. **3**And this we will
do if God permits.[l] **4**For it is impossible * to restore again to repentance
those who have once been enlightened, who have tasted the heavenly gift,
and have become partakers of the Holy Spirit, **5**and have tasted the
goodness of the word of God and the powers of the age to come, **6**if they
then commit apostasy, since they crucify the Son of God on their own
account and hold him up to contempt. **7**For land which has drunk the rain
that often falls upon it, and brings forth vegetation useful to those for whose
sake it is cultivated, receives a blessing from God. **8**But if it bears thorns
and thistles, it is worthless and near to being cursed; its end is to be burned.

9 Though we speak thus, yet in your case, beloved, we feel sure of better
things that belong to salvation. **10**For God is not so unjust as to overlook
your work and the love which you showed for his sake in serving the saints,
as you still do. **11**And we desire each one of you to show the same
earnestness in realizing the full assurance of hope until the end, **12**so that
you may not be sluggish, but imitators of those who through faith and
patience inherit the promises.

The Certainty of God's Promise

13 For when God made a promise to Abraham, since he had no one
greater by whom to swear, he swore by himself, **14**saying, "Surely I will
bless you and multiply you." **15**And thus Abraham,[m] having patiently
endured, obtained the promise. **16**Men indeed swear by a greater than
themselves, and in all their disputes an oath is final for confirmation. **17**So

when God desired to show more convincingly to the heirs of the promise
the unchangeable character of his purpose, he interposed with an oath, 18so
that through two unchangeable things, in which it is impossible that God
should prove false, we who have fled for refuge might have strong
encouragement to seize the hope set before us. 19We have this as a sure and
steadfast anchor of the soul, a hope that enters into the inner shrine behind
the curtain, 20where Jesus has gone as a forerunner on our behalf, having
become a high priest for ever according to the order of Melchiz'edek.

The Priestly Order of Melchizedek

7 For this Melchiz'edek, king of Salem, priest of the Most High God,
met Abraham returning from the slaughter of the kings and blessed him;
2and to him Abraham apportioned a tenth part of everything. He is first, by
translation of his name, king of righteousness, and then he is also king of
Salem, that is, king of peace. 3He is without father * or mother or
genealogy, and has neither beginning of days nor end of life, * but
resembling the Son of God he continues a priest for ever.

4 See how great he is! Abraham the patriarch gave him a tithe of the
spoils. 5And those descendants of Levi who receive the priestly office have
a commandment in the law to take tithes from the people, that is, from their
brethren, though these also are descended from Abraham. 6But this man
who has not their genealogy received tithes from Abraham and blessed him
who had the promises. 7It is beyond dispute that the inferior is blessed by
the superior. 8Here tithes are received by mortal men; there, by one of
whom it is testified that he lives. 9One might even say that Levi himself,
who receives tithes, paid tithes through Abraham, 10for he was still in the
loins of his ancestor when Melchiz'edek met him.

Another Priest, according to the Order of Melchizedek

11 Now if perfection had been attainable through the Levitical priesthood
(for under it the people received the law), what further need would there
have been for another priest to arise according to the order of Melchiz'edek,
rather than one named according to the order of Aaron? 12For when there is
a change in the priesthood, there is necessarily a change in the law as well.
13For the one of whom these things are spoken belonged to another tribe,
from which no one has ever served at the altar. 14For it is evident that our

Lord was descended from Judah, and in connection with that tribe Moses said nothing about priests.

15 This becomes even more evident when another priest arises in the likeness of Melchiz'edek, **16**who has become a priest, not according to a legal requirement concerning bodily descent but by the power of an indestructible life. **17**For it is witnessed of him,

"You are a priest for ever,
according to the order of Melchiz'edek."

18On the one hand, a former commandment is set aside because of its weakness and uselessness **19**(for the law made nothing perfect); on the other hand, a better hope is introduced, through which we draw near to God.

20 And it was not without an oath. **21**Those who formerly became priests took their office without an oath, but this one was addressed with an oath,

"The Lord has sworn
and will not change his mind,
'You are a priest for ever.' "

22This makes Jesus the surety of a better covenant.

23 The former priests were many in number, because they were prevented by death from continuing in office; **24**but he holds his priesthood permanently, because he continues for ever. **25**Consequently he is able for all time to save those who draw near to God through him, since he always lives to make intercession for them.

26 For it was fitting that we should have such a high priest, holy, blameless, unstained, separated from sinners, exalted above the heavens. **27**He has no need, like those high priests, to offer sacrifices daily, first for his own sins and then for those of the people; he did this once for all when he offered up himself. **28**Indeed, the law appoints men in their weakness as high priests, but the word of the oath, which came later than the law, appoints a Son who has been made perfect for ever.

Mediator of a New Covenant

8 Now the point in what we are saying is this: we have such a high priest, one who is seated at the right hand of the throne of the Majesty in heaven, **2**a minister in the sanctuary and the true tent[n] which is set up not by man but by the Lord. **3**For every high priest is appointed to offer gifts and sacrifices; hence it is necessary for this priest also to have something to

offer. [4]Now if he were on earth, he would not be a priest at all, since there are priests who offer gifts according to the law. [5]They serve a copy and shadow of the heavenly sanctuary; for when Moses was about to erect the tent,[n] he was instructed by God, saying, “See that you make everything according to the pattern which was shown you on the mountain.” [6]But as it is, Christ[o] has obtained a ministry which is as much more excellent than the old as the covenant he mediates is better, since it is enacted on better promises. [7]For if that first covenant had been faultless, there would have been no occasion for a second.

[8] For he finds fault with them when he says:

“The days will come, says the Lord,
when I will establish a new covenant with the house of Israel
and with the house of Judah;
[9]not like the covenant that I made with their fathers
on the day when I took them by the hand
to lead them out of the land of Egypt;
for they did not continue in my covenant,
and so I paid no heed to them, says the Lord.
[10]This is the covenant that I will make with the house of Israel
after those days, says the Lord:
I will put my laws into their minds,
and write them on their hearts,
and I will be their God,
and they shall be my people.
[11]And they shall not teach every one his fellow
or every one his brother, saying, ‘Know the Lord,’
for all shall know me,
from the least of them to the greatest. *
[12]For I will be merciful toward their iniquities,
and I will remember their sins no more.”

[13]In speaking of a new covenant he treats the first as obsolete. And what is becoming obsolete and growing old is ready to vanish away.

The Earthly and the Heavenly Sanctuaries

9 Now even the first covenant had regulations for worship and an earthly sanctuary. 2For a tent[p] was prepared, the outer one, in which were the lampstand and the table and the bread of offering;[q] it is called the Holy Place. 3Behind the second curtain stood a tent[p] called the Holy of Holies, 4having the golden altar of incense and the ark of the covenant covered on all sides with gold, which contained a golden urn holding the manna, and Aaron's rod that budded, and the tables of the covenant; 5above it were the cherubim of glory overshadowing the mercy seat. Of these things we cannot now speak in detail.

6 These preparations having thus been made, the priests go continually into the outer tent,[p] performing their ritual duties; 7but into the second only the high priest goes, and he but once a year, and not without taking blood which he offers for himself and for the errors of the people. **8**By this the Holy Spirit indicates that the way into the sanctuary is not yet opened as long as the outer tent[p] is still standing **9**(which is symbolic for the present age). According to this arrangement, gifts and sacrifices are offered which cannot perfect the conscience of the worshiper, **10**but deal only with food and drink and various baptisms, regulations for the body imposed until the time of reformation.

11 But when Christ appeared as a high priest of the good things that have come,[r] then through the greater and more perfect tent[p] (not made with hands, that is, not of this creation) **12**he entered once for all into the Holy Place, taking[s] not the blood of goats and calves but his own blood, thus securing an eternal redemption. 13For if the sprinkling of defiled persons with the blood of goats and bulls and with the ashes of a heifer sanctifies for the purification of the flesh, **14**how much more shall the blood of Christ, who through the eternal Spirit offered himself without blemish to God, purify your[t] conscience from dead works to serve the living God.

15 Therefore he is the mediator of a new covenant, so that those who are called may receive the promised eternal inheritance, since a death has occurred which redeems them from the transgressions under the first covenant.[u] **16**For where a will[u] is involved, the death of the one who made it must be established. **17**For a will[u] takes effect only at death, since it is not in force as long as the one who made it is alive. **18**Hence even the first covenant was not ratified without blood. 19For when every commandment

of the law had been declared by Moses to all the people, he took the blood of calves and goats, with water and scarlet wool and hyssop, and sprinkled both the book itself and all the people, [20]saying, “This is the blood of the covenant which God commanded you.” [21]And in the same way he sprinkled with the blood both the tent[p] and all the vessels used in worship. [22]Indeed, under the law almost everything is purified with blood, and without the shedding of blood there is no forgiveness of sins.

Christ’s Sacrifice Takes Away Sin

23 Thus it was necessary for the copies of the heavenly things to be purified with these rites, but the heavenly things themselves with better sacrifices than these. [24]For Christ has entered, not into a sanctuary made with hands, a copy of the true one, but into heaven itself, now to appear in the presence of God on our behalf. [25]Nor was it to offer himself repeatedly, as the high priest enters the Holy Place yearly with blood not his own; [26]for then he would have had to suffer repeatedly since the foundation of the world. But as it is, he has appeared once for all at the end of the age to put away sin by the sacrifice of himself. [27]And just as it is appointed for men to die once, and after that comes judgment, [28]so Christ, having been offered once to bear the sins of many, will appear a second time, not to deal with sin but to save those who are eagerly waiting for him.

Christ’s Sacrifice Once for All

10 * For since the law has but a shadow of the good things to come instead of the true form of these realities, it can never, by the same sacrifices which are continually offered year after year, make perfect those who draw near. [2]Otherwise, would they not have ceased to be offered? If the worshipers had once been cleansed, they would no longer have any consciousness of sin. [3]But in these sacrifices there is a reminder of sin year after year. [4]For it is impossible that the blood of bulls and goats should take away sins.

5 Consequently, when Christ[v] came into the world, he said,

“Sacrifices and offerings you have not desired,
but a body have you prepared for me;
[6]in burnt offerings and sin offerings you have taken no pleasure.
[7]Then I said, ‘Behold, I have come to do your will, O God,’
as it is written of me in the roll of the book.”

[8]When he said above, “You have neither desired nor taken pleasure in
sacrifices and offerings and burnt offerings and sin offerings” (these are
offered according to the law), [9]then he added, “Behold, I have come to do
your will.” He abolishes the first in order to establish the second. [10]And by
that will we have been sanctified through the offering of the body of Jesus
Christ once for all.

11 And every priest stands daily at his service, offering repeatedly the
same sacrifices, which can never take away sins. [12]But when Christ[w] had
offered for all time a single sacrifice for sins, he sat down at the right hand
of God, [13]then to wait until his enemies should be made a stool for his feet.
[14]For by a single offering he has perfected for all time those who are
sanctified. [15]And the Holy Spirit also bears witness to us; for after saying,

[16]“This is the covenant that I will make with them
after those days, says the Lord:
I will put my laws on their hearts,
and write them on their minds,”

[17]then he adds,

“I will remember their sins and their misdeeds no more.”

[18]Where there is forgiveness of these, there is no longer any offering for
sin.

A Call to Persevere

19 Therefore, brethren, since we have confidence to enter the sanctuary by
the blood of Jesus, [20]by the new and living way which he opened for us
through the curtain, that is, through his flesh, [21]and since we have a great
priest over the house of God, [22]let us draw near with a true heart in full
assurance of faith, with our hearts sprinkled clean from an evil conscience
and our bodies washed with pure water. [23]Let us hold fast the confession of
our hope without wavering, for he who promised is faithful; [24]and let us
consider how to stir up one another to love and good works, [25]not
neglecting to meet together, as is the habit of some, but encouraging one
another, and all the more as you see the Day drawing near.

26 For if we sin deliberately after receiving the knowledge of the truth,
there no longer remains a sacrifice for sins, [27]but a fearful prospect of
judgment, and a fury of fire which will consume the adversaries. [28]A man
who has violated the law of Moses dies without mercy at the testimony of

two or three witnesses. [29]How much worse punishment do you think will be deserved by the man who has spurned the Son of God, and profaned the blood of the covenant by which he was sanctified, and outraged the Spirit of grace? [30]For we know him who said, “Vengeance is mine, I will repay.” And again, “The Lord will judge his people.” [31]It is a fearful thing to fall into the hands of the living God.

32 But recall the former days when, after you were enlightened, you endured a hard struggle with sufferings, [33]sometimes being publicly exposed to abuse and affliction, and sometimes being partners with those so treated. [34]For you had compassion on the prisoners, and you joyfully accepted the plundering of your property, since you knew that you yourselves had a better possession and an abiding one. [35]Therefore do not throw away your confidence, which has a great reward. [36]For you have need of endurance, so that you may do the will of God and receive what is promised.

[37]“For yet a little while,
and the coming one shall come and shall not tarry;
[38]but my righteous one shall live by faith,
and if he shrinks back,
my soul has no pleasure in him.”

[39]But we are not of those who shrink back and are destroyed, but of those who have faith and keep their souls.

The Meaning of Faith

11 Now faith is the assurance of things hoped for, the conviction of things not seen. [2]For by it the men of old received divine approval. [3]By faith we understand that the world was created by the word of God, so that what is seen was made out of things which do not appear.

The Examples of Abel, Enoch, and Noah

[4] By faith Abel offered to God a more acceptable sacrifice than Cain, through which he received approval as righteous, God bearing witness by accepting his gifts; he died, but through his faith he is still speaking. [5]By faith E'noch was taken up so that he should not see death; and he was not found, because God had taken him. Now before he was taken he was attested as having pleased God. [6]And without faith it is impossible to please him. For whoever would draw near to God must believe that he exists and

that he rewards those who seek him. * 7By faith Noah, being warned by God concerning events as yet unseen, took heed and constructed an ark for the saving of his household; by this he condemned the world and became an heir of the righteousness which comes by faith.

The Faith of Abraham

8 By faith Abraham obeyed when he was called to go out to a place which he was to receive as an inheritance; and he went out, not knowing where he was to go. 9By faith he sojourned in the land of promise, as in a foreign land, living in tents with Isaac and Jacob, heirs with him of the same promise. 10For he looked forward to the city which has foundations, whose builder and maker is God. 11By faith Sarah herself received power to conceive, even when she was past the age, since she considered him faithful who had promised. 12Therefore from one man, and him as good as dead, were born descendants as many as the stars of heaven and as the innumerable grains of sand by the seashore.

13 These all died in faith, not having received what was promised, but having seen it and greeted it from afar, and having acknowledged that they were strangers and exiles on the earth. 14For people who speak thus make it clear that they are seeking a homeland. 15If they had been thinking of that land from which they had gone out, they would have had opportunity to return. 16But as it is, they desire a better country, that is, a heavenly one. Therefore God is not ashamed to be called their God, for he has prepared for them a city.

17 By faith Abraham, when he was tested, offered up Isaac, and he who had received the promises was ready to offer up his only-begotten son, 18of whom it was said, “Through Isaac shall your descendants be named.” 19He considered that God was able to raise men even from the dead; hence he did receive him back and this was a symbol. 20By faith Isaac invoked future blessings on Jacob and Esau. 21By faith Jacob, when dying, blessed each of the sons of Joseph, bowing in worship over the head of his staff. 22By faith Joseph, at the end of his life, made mention of the exodus of the Israelites and gave directions concerning his burial.x

The Faith of Moses

23 By faith Moses, when he was born, was hidden for three months by his parents, because they saw that the child was beautiful; and they were not afraid of the king’s edict. 24By faith Moses, when he was grown up, refused

to be called the son of Pharaoh's daughter, [25]choosing rather to share ill-treatment with the people of God than to enjoy the fleeting pleasures of sin. [26]He considered abuse suffered for the Christ greater wealth than the treasures of Egypt, for he looked to the reward. [27]By faith he left Egypt, not being afraid of the anger of the king; for he endured as seeing him who is invisible. [28]By faith he kept the Passover and sprinkled the blood, so that the Destroyer of the first-born might not touch them.

The Faith of Other Heroesin Israel's History

[29] By faith the people crossed the Red Sea as if on dry land; but the Egyptians, when they attempted to do the same, were drowned. [30]By faith the walls of Jericho fell down after they had been encircled for seven days. [31]By faith Rahab the harlot did not perish with those who were disobedient, because she had given friendly welcome to the spies.

[32] And what more shall I say? For time would fail me to tell of Gideon, Barak, Samson, Jephthah, of David and Samuel and the prophets—[33]who through faith conquered kingdoms, enforced justice, received promises, stopped the mouths of lions, [34]quenched raging fire, escaped the edge of the sword, won strength out of weakness, became mighty in war, put foreign armies to flight. [35]Women received their dead by resurrection. Some were tortured, refusing to accept release, that they might rise again to a better life. [36]Others suffered mocking and scourging, and even chains and imprisonment. [37]They were stoned, they were sawn in two,[y] they were killed with the sword; they went about in skins of sheep and goats, destitute, afflicted, ill-treated— [38]of whom the world was not worthy—wandering over deserts and mountains, and in dens and caves of the earth.

39 And all these, though well attested by their faith, did not receive what was promised, [40]since God had foreseen something better for us, that apart from us they should not be made perfect.

The Example of Jesus

12 Therefore, since we are surrounded by so great a cloud of witnesses, let us also lay aside every weight, and sin which clings so closely, and let us run with perseverance the race that is set before us, [*] [2]looking to Jesus the pioneer and perfecter of our faith, who for the joy that was set before him endured the cross, despising the shame, and is seated at the right hand of the throne of God.

3 Consider him who endured from sinners such hostility against himself,
so that you may not grow weary or fainthearted. **4**In your struggle against
sin you have not yet resisted to the point of shedding your blood. **5**And have
you forgotten the exhortation which addresses you as sons?—

"My son, do not regard lightly the discipline of the Lord,
nor lose courage when you are punished by him.
6For the Lord disciplines him whom he loves,
and chastises every son whom he receives."

7It is for discipline that you have to endure. God is treating you as sons;
for what son is there whom his father does not discipline? **8**If you are left
without discipline, in which all have participated, then you are illegitimate
children and not sons. **9**Besides this, we have had earthly fathers to
discipline us and we respected them. Shall we not much more be subject to
the Father of spirits and live? **10**For they disciplined us for a short time at
their pleasure, but he disciplines us for our good, that we may share his
holiness. **11**For the moment all discipline seems painful rather than pleasant;
later it yields the peaceful fruit of righteousness to those who have been
trained by it.

Exhortation to Be Strong and Avoid Sin

12 Therefore lift your drooping hands and strengthen your weak knees,
13and make straight paths for your feet, so that what is lame may not be put
out of joint but rather be healed. **14**Strive for peace with all men, and for the
holiness without which no one will see the Lord. **15**See to it that no one fail
to obtain the grace of God; that no "root of bitterness" spring up and cause
trouble, and by it the many become defiled; **16**that no one be immoral or
irreligious like Esau, who sold his birthright for a single meal. **17**For you
know that afterward, when he desired to inherit the blessing, he was
rejected, for he found no chance to repent, though he sought it with tears.

18 For you have not come to what may be touched, a blazing fire, and
darkness, and gloom, and a tempest, **19**and the sound of a trumpet, and a
voice whose words made the hearers entreat that no further messages be
spoken to them. **20**For they could not endure the order that was given, "If
even a beast touches the mountain, it shall be stoned." **21**Indeed, so
terrifying was the sight that Moses said, "I tremble with fear." **22**But you
have come to Mount Zion and to the city of the living God, the heavenly

Jerusalem, and to innumerable angels in festal gathering, 23and to the assembly[z] of the first-born who are enrolled in heaven, and to a judge who is God of all, and to the spirits of just men made perfect, 24and to Jesus, the mediator of a new covenant, and to the sprinkled blood that speaks more graciously than the blood of Abel.

25 See that you do not refuse him who is speaking. For if they did not escape when they refused him who warned them on earth, much less shall we escape if we reject him who warns from heaven. 26His voice then shook the earth; but now he has promised, "Yet once more I will shake not only the earth but also the heaven." 27This phrase, "Yet once more," indicates the removal of what is shaken, as of what has been made, in order that what cannot be shaken may remain. 28Therefore let us be grateful for receiving a kingdom that cannot be shaken, and thus let us offer to God acceptable worship, with reverence and awe; 29for our God is a consuming fire.

Sacrifices Well-Pleasing to God

13 * Let brotherly love continue. 2Do not neglect to show hospitality to strangers, for thereby some have entertained angels unawares. 3Remember those who are in prison, as though in prison with them; and those who are ill-treated, since you also are in the body. 4Let marriage be held in honor among all, and let the marriage bed be undefiled; for God will judge the immoral and adulterous. 5Keep your life free from love of money, and be content with what you have; for he has said, "I will never fail you nor forsake you." 6Hence we can confidently say,

"The Lord is my helper,
I will not be afraid;
what can man do to me?"

7 Remember your leaders, those who spoke to you the word of God; consider the outcome of their life, and imitate their faith. 8Jesus Christ is the same yesterday and today and for ever. 9Do not be led away by diverse and strange teachings; for it is well that the heart be strengthened by grace, not by foods, which have not benefited their adherents. * 10We have an altar from which those who serve the tent[a] have no right to eat. 11For the bodies of those animals whose blood is brought into the sanctuary by the high priest as a sacrifice for sin are burned outside the camp. 12So Jesus also suffered outside the gate in order to sanctify the people through his own

blood. [13]Therefore let us go forth to him outside the camp, bearing abuse for him. * [14]For here we have no lasting city, but we seek the city which is to come. [15]Through him then let us continually offer up a sacrifice of praise to God, that is, the fruit of lips that acknowledge his name. [16]Do not neglect to do good and to share what you have, for such sacrifices are pleasing to God.

17 Obey your leaders and submit to them; for they are keeping watch over your souls, as men who will have to give account. Let them do this joyfully, and not sadly, for that would be of no advantage to you.

18 Pray for us, for we are sure that we have a clear conscience, desiring to act honorably in all things. [19]I urge you the more earnestly to do this in order that I may be restored to you the sooner.

Benediction

20 Now may the God of peace who brought again from the dead our Lord Jesus, the great shepherd of the sheep, by the blood of the eternal covenant, [21]equip you with everything good that you may do his will, working in you[b] that which is pleasing in his sight, through Jesus Christ; to whom be glory for ever and ever. Amen.

Final Exhortation and Greetings

22 I appeal to you, brethren, bear with my word of exhortation, for I have written to you briefly. [23]You should understand that our brother Timothy has been released, with whom I shall see you if he comes soon. [24]Greet all your leaders and all the saints. Those who come from Italy send you greetings. [25]Grace be with all of you. Amen.

James

Chapters

1 2 3 4 5

THE LETTER OF JAMES

Salutation

1 James, a servant of God and of the Lord Jesus Christ,

To the twelve tribes * in the Dispersion:
Greeting.

Faith and Wisdom

2 Count it all joy, my brethren, when you meet various trials, **3**for you know that the testing of your faith produces steadfastness. **4**And let steadfastness have its full effect, that you may be perfect and complete, lacking in nothing.

5 If any of you lacks wisdom, let him ask God, who gives to all men generously and without reproaching, and it will be given him. **6**But let him ask in faith, with no doubting, for he who doubts is like a wave of the sea that is driven and tossed by the wind. **7, 8**For that person must not suppose that a double-minded man, unstable in all his ways, will receive anything from the Lord.

Poverty and Riches

9 Let the lowly brother boast in his exaltation, **10**and the rich in his humiliation, because like the flower of the grass he will pass away. **11**For the sun rises with its scorching heat and withers the grass; its flower falls, and its beauty perishes. So will the rich man fade away in the midst of his pursuits.

Trial and Temptation

12 Blessed is the man who endures trial, for when he has stood the test he will receive the crown of life which God has promised to those who love him. **13**Let no one say when he is tempted, “I am tempted by God”; for God cannot be tempted with evil and he himself tempts no one; **14**but each person is tempted when he is lured and enticed by his own desire. **15**Then desire when it has conceived gives birth to sin; and sin when it is full-grown brings forth death.

16 Do not be deceived, my beloved brethren. **17**Every good endowment and every perfect gift is from above, coming down from the Father of lights with whom there is no variation or shadow due to change.[a] **18**Of his own will he brought us forth by the word of truth that we should be a kind of first fruits of his creatures.

19 Know this, my beloved brethren. Let every man be quick to hear, slow
to speak, slow to anger, **20**for the anger of man does not work the
righteousness of God. **21**Therefore put away all filthiness and rank growth
of wickedness and receive with meekness the implanted word, which is able
to save your souls.

22 But be doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving yourselves. *
23For if any one is a hearer of the word and not a doer, he is like a man who
observes his natural face in a mirror; **24**for he observes himself and goes
away and at once forgets what he was like. **25**But he who looks into the
perfect law, the law of liberty, and perseveres, being no hearer that forgets
but a doer that acts, he shall be blessed in his doing.

26 If any one thinks he is religious, and does not bridle his tongue but
deceives his heart, this man's religion is vain. **27**Religion that is pure and
undefiled before God and the Father is this: to visit orphans and widows in
their affliction, and to keep oneself unstained from the world.

Warning against Partiality

2 * My brethren, show no partiality as you hold the faith of our Lord
Jesus Christ, the Lord of glory. **2**For if a man with gold rings and in fine
clothing comes into your assembly, and a poor man in shabby clothing also
comes in, **3**and you pay attention to the one who wears the fine clothing and
say, "Have a seat here, please," while you say to the poor man, "Stand
there," or, "Sit at my feet," **4**have you not made distinctions among
yourselves, and become judges with evil thoughts? **5**Listen, my beloved
brethren. Has not God chosen those who are poor in the world to be rich in
faith and heirs of the kingdom which he has promised to those who love
him? **6**But you have dishonored the poor man. Is it not the rich who oppress
you, is it not they who drag you into court? **7**Is it not they who blaspheme
that honorable name by which you are called?

8 If you really fulfil the royal law, according to the Scripture, "You shall
love your neighbor as yourself," you do well. **9**But if you show partiality,
you commit sin, and are convicted by the law as transgressors. **10**For
whoever keeps the whole law but fails in one point has become guilty of all
of it. * **11**For he who said, "Do not commit adultery," said also, "Do not
kill." If you do not commit adultery but do kill, you have become a
transgressor of the law. **12**So speak and so act as those who are to be judged

under the law of liberty. [13]For judgment is without mercy to one who has shown no mercy; yet mercy triumphs over judgment.

Faith without Works Is Dead

14 What does it profit, my brethren, if a man says he has faith but has not works? Can his faith save him? * [15]If a brother or sister is poorly clothed and in lack of daily food, [16]and one of you says to them, “Go in peace, be warmed and filled,” without giving them the things needed for the body, what does it profit? [17]So faith by itself, if it has no works, is dead.

18 But some one will say, “You have faith and I have works.” Show me your faith apart from your works, and I by my works will show you my faith. [19]You believe that God is one; you do well. Even the demons believe —and shudder. [20]Do you want to be shown, you foolish fellow, that faith apart from works is barren? [21]Was not Abraham our father justified by works, when he offered his son Isaac upon the altar? [22]You see that faith was active along with his works, and faith was completed by works, [23]and the Scripture was fulfilled which says, “Abraham believed God, and it was reckoned to him as righteousness”; and he was called the friend of God. [24]You see that a man is justified by works and not by faith alone. [25]And in the same way was not also Ra'hab the harlot justified by works when she received the messengers and sent them out another way? [26]For as the body apart from the spirit is dead, so faith apart from works is dead.

Taming the Tongue

3 Let not many of you become teachers, my brethren, for you know that we who teach shall be judged with greater strictness. [2]For we all make many mistakes, and if any one makes no mistakes in what he says he is a perfect man, able to bridle the whole body also. [3]If we put bits into the mouths of horses that they may obey us, we guide their whole bodies. [4]Look at the ships also; though they are so great and are driven by strong winds, they are guided by a very small rudder wherever the will of the pilot directs. [5]So the tongue is a little member and boasts of great things. How great a forest is set ablaze by a small fire!

6 And the tongue is a fire. The tongue is an unrighteous world among our members, staining the whole body, setting on fire the cycle of nature,[b] and set on fire by hell.[c] [7]For every kind of beast and bird, of reptile and sea creature, can be tamed and has been tamed by mankind, [8]but no human

being can tame the tongue—a restless evil, full of deadly poison. [9]With it we bless the Lord and Father, and with it we curse men, who are made in the likeness of God. [10]From the same mouth come blessing and cursing. My brethren, this ought not to be so. [11]Does a spring pour forth from the same opening fresh water and brackish? [12]Can a fig tree, my brethren, yield olives, or a grapevine figs? No more can salt water yield fresh.

Two Kinds of Wisdom

13 Who is wise and understanding among you? By his good life let him show his works in the meekness of wisdom. [14]But if you have bitter jealousy and selfish ambition in your hearts, do not boast and be false to the truth. [15]This wisdom is not such as comes down from above, but is earthly, unspiritual, devilish. [16]For where jealousy and selfish ambition exist, there will be disorder and every vile practice. [17]But the wisdom from above is first pure, then peaceable, gentle, open to reason, full of mercy and good fruits, without uncertainty or insincerity. [18]And the harvest of righteousness is sown in peace by those who make peace.

Friendship with the World

4 What causes wars, and what causes fightings among you? Is it not your passions that are at war in your members? [2]You desire and do not have; so you kill. And you covet[d] and cannot obtain; so you fight and wage war. You do not have, because you do not ask. [3]You ask and do not receive, because you ask wrongly, to spend it on your passions. [4]Unfaithful creatures! Do you not know that friendship with the world is enmity with God? Therefore whoever wishes to be a friend of the world makes himself an enemy of God. [5]Or do you suppose it is in vain that the Scripture says, "He yearns jealously over the spirit which he has made to dwell in us"? [6]But he gives more grace; therefore it says, "God opposes the proud, but gives grace to the humble." [7]Submit yourselves therefore to God. Resist the devil and he will flee from you. [8]Draw near to God and he will draw near to you. Cleanse your hands, you sinners, and purify your hearts, you men of double mind. [9]Be wretched and mourn and weep. Let your laughter be turned to mourning and your joy to dejection. [10]Humble yourselves before the Lord and he will exalt you.

Warning against Judging Another

11 Do not speak evil against one another, brethren. He that speaks evil against a brother or judges his brother, speaks evil against the law and judges the law. But if you judge the law, you are not a doer of the law but a judge. **12**There is one lawgiver and judge, he who is able to save and to destroy. But who are you that you judge your neighbor?

Boasting about Tomorrow

13 Come now, you who say, “Today or tomorrow we will go into such and such a town and spend a year there and trade and get gain”; **14**whereas you do not know about tomorrow. What is your life? For you are a mist that appears for a little time and then vanishes. **15**Instead you ought to say, “If the Lord wills, we shall live and we shall do this or that.” **16**As it is, you boast in your arrogance. All such boasting is evil. **17**Whoever knows what is right to do and fails to do it, for him it is sin.

Warning to Rich Oppressors

5 Come now, you rich, weep and howl for the miseries that are coming upon you. **2**Your riches have rotted and your garments are moth-eaten. **3**Your gold and silver have rusted, and their rust will be evidence against you and will eat your flesh like fire. You have laid up treasure[e] * for the last days. **4**Behold, the wages of the laborers who mowed your fields, which you kept back by fraud, cry out; and the cries of the harvesters have reached the ears of the Lord of hosts. **5**You have lived on the earth in luxury and in pleasure; you have fattened your hearts in a day of slaughter. **6**You have condemned, you have killed the righteous man; he does not resist you.

Patience in Suffering

7 Be patient, therefore, brethren, until the coming of the Lord. Behold, the farmer waits for the precious fruit of the earth, being patient over it until it receives the early and the late rain. **8**You also be patient. Establish your hearts, for the coming of the Lord is at hand. **9**Do not grumble, brethren, against one another, that you may not be judged; behold, the Judge is standing at the doors. **10**As an example of suffering and patience, brethren, take the prophets who spoke in the name of the Lord. **11**Behold, we call those happy who were steadfast. You have heard of the steadfastness of Job, and you have seen the purpose of the Lord, how the Lord is compassionate and merciful.

12 But above all, my brethren, do not swear, either by heaven or by earth
or with any other oath, but let your yes be yes and your no be no, that you
may not fall under condemnation.

The Prayer of Faith

13 * Is any one among you suffering? Let him pray. Is any cheerful? Let
him sing praise. 14Is any among you sick? Let him call for the elders of the
Church, and let them pray over him, anointing him with oil in the name of
the Lord; 15and the prayer of faith will save the sick man, and the Lord will
raise him up; and if he has committed sins, he will be forgiven. 16Therefore
confess your sins to one another, and pray for one another, that you may be
healed. The prayer of a righteous man has great power in its effects.
17Eli'jah was a man of like nature with ourselves and he prayed fervently
that it might not rain, and for three years and six months it did not rain on
the earth. 18Then he prayed again and the heaven gave rain, and the earth
brought forth its fruit.

19 My brethren, if any one among you wanders from the truth and some
one brings him back, 20let him know that whoever brings back a sinner
from the error of his way will save his soul from death and will cover a
multitude of sins.

1 Peter

Chapters

1 2 3 4 5

THE FIRST LETTER OF PETER

Salutation

1 * Peter, an apostle of Jesus Christ,

To the exiles of the Dispersion in Pontus, Galatia, Cappado'cia, Asia, and Bithyn'ia, **2**chosen and destined by God the Father and sanctified by the Spirit for obedience to Jesus Christ and for sprinkling with his blood:

May grace and peace be multiplied to you.

A Living Hope

3 Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ! By his great mercy we have been born anew to a living hope through the resurrection of Jesus Christ from the dead, **4**and to an inheritance which is imperishable, undefiled, and unfading, kept in heaven for you, **5**who by God's power are guarded through faith for a salvation ready to be revealed in the last time. **6**In this you rejoice,[a] though now for a little while you may have to suffer various trials, **7**so that the genuineness of your faith, more precious than gold which though perishable is tested by fire, may redound to praise and glory and honor at the revelation of Jesus Christ. **8**Without having seen[b] him you[c] love him; though you do not now see him you believe in him and rejoice with unutterable and exalted joy. **9**As the outcome of your faith you obtain the salvation of your souls.

10 The prophets who prophesied of the grace that was to be yours searched and inquired about this salvation; **11**they inquired what person or time was indicated by the Spirit of Christ * within them when predicting the sufferings of Christ and the subsequent glory. **12**It was revealed to them that they were serving not themselves but you, in the things which have now been announced to you by those who preached the good news to you through the Holy Spirit sent from heaven, things into which angels long to look.

A Call to Holy Living

13 Therefore gird up your minds, be sober, set your hope fully upon the grace that is coming to you at the revelation of Jesus Christ. **14**As obedient children, do not be conformed to the passions of your former ignorance, **15**but as he who called you is holy, be holy yourselves in all your conduct; **16**since it is written, "You shall be holy, for I am holy." **17**And if you invoke as Father him who judges each one impartially according to his deeds,

conduct yourselves with fear throughout the time of your exile. 18You know
that you were ransomed from the futile ways inherited from your fathers,
not with perishable things such as silver or gold, 19but with the precious
blood of Christ, like that of a lamb without blemish or spot. 20He was
destined before the foundation of the world but was made manifest at the
end of the times for your sake. 21Through him you have confidence in God,
who raised him from the dead and gave him glory, so that your faith and
hope are in God.[d]

22 Having purified your souls by your obedience to the truth for a sincere
love of the brethren, love one another earnestly from the heart. 23You have
been born anew, not of perishable seed but of imperishable, through the
living and abiding word of God; [24]for

"All flesh is like grass
and all its glory like the flower of grass.
The grass withers, and the flower falls,
25but the word of the Lord abides for ever."

That word is the good news which was preached to you.

The Living Stone and a Chosen People

2 So put away all malice and all guile and insincerity and envy and all
slander. 2Like newborn infants, long for the pure spiritual milk, that by it
you may grow up to salvation; [3]for you have tasted the kindness of the
Lord.

[4] Come to him, to that living stone, rejected by men but in God's sight
chosen and precious; 5and like living stones be yourselves built into a
spiritual house, to be a holy priesthood, to offer spiritual sacrifices
acceptable to God through Jesus Christ. [6]For it stands in Scripture:

"Behold, I am laying in Zion a stone, a cornerstone chosen and
precious,
and he who believes in him will not be put to shame."

[7]To you therefore who believe, he is precious, but for those who do not
believe,

"The very stone which the builders rejected
has become the cornerstone,"

[8]and

"A stone that will make men stumble,

a rock that will make them fall”;
for they stumble because they disobey the word, as they were destined to do.

9 But you are a chosen race, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, God’s own people,[e] that you may declare the wonderful deeds of him who called you out of darkness into his marvelous light. 10Once you were no people but now you are God’s people; once you had not received mercy but now you have received mercy.

Live as Servants of God

11 Beloved, I beg you as aliens and exiles to abstain from the passions of the flesh that wage war against your soul. 12Maintain good conduct among the Gentiles, so that in case they speak against you as wrongdoers, they may see your good deeds and glorify God on the day of visitation.

13 Be subject for the Lord’s sake to every human institution,[f] whether it be to the emperor as supreme, 14or to governors as sent by him to punish those who do wrong and to praise those who do right. 15For it is God’s will that by doing right you should put to silence the ignorance of foolish men. 16Live as free men, yet without using your freedom as a pretext for evil; but live as servants of God. 17Honor all men. Love the brotherhood. Fear God. Honor the emperor.

The Example of Christ’s Suffering

18 Servants, be submissive to your masters with all respect, not only to the kind and gentle but also to the overbearing. 19For one is approved if, mindful of God, he endures pain while suffering unjustly. 20For what credit is it, if when you do wrong and are beaten for it you take it patiently? But if when you do right and suffer for it you take it patiently, you have God’s approval. 21For to this you have been called, because Christ also suffered for you, leaving you an example, that you should follow in his steps. 22He committed no sin; no guile was found on his lips. 23When he was reviled, he did not revile in return; when he suffered, he did not threaten; but he trusted to him who judges justly. 24He himself bore our sins in his body on the tree,[g] that we might die to sin and live to righteousness. By his wounds you have been healed. 25For you were straying like sheep, but have now returned to the Shepherd and Guardian of your souls.

Wives and Husbands

3 * Likewise you wives, be submissive to your husbands, so that some, though they do not obey the word, may be won without a word by the behavior of their wives, **2**when they see your reverent and chaste behavior. **3**Let not yours be the outward adorning with braiding of hair, decoration of gold, and wearing of robes, **4**but let it be the hidden person of the heart with the imperishable jewel of a gentle and quiet spirit, which in God's sight is very precious. **5**So once the holy women who hoped in God used to adorn themselves and were submissive to their husbands, **6**as Sarah obeyed Abraham, calling him lord. And you are now her children if you do right and let nothing terrify you.

7 Likewise you husbands, live considerately with your wives, bestowing honor on the woman as the weaker sex, since you are joint heirs of the grace of life, in order that your prayers may not be hindered.

Suffering for Doing Right

8 Finally, all of you, have unity of spirit, sympathy, love of the brethren, a tender heart and a humble mind. **9**Do not return evil for evil or reviling for reviling; but on the contrary bless, for to this you have been called, that you may obtain a blessing. **10**For

> "He that would love life
> and see good days,
> let him keep his tongue from evil
> and his lips from speaking guile;
> **11**let him turn away from evil and do right;
> let him seek peace and pursue it.
> **12**For the eyes of the Lord are upon the righteous,
> and his ears are open to their prayer.
> But the face of the Lord is against those that do evil."

13 Now who is there to harm you if you are zealous for what is right? **14**But even if you do suffer for righteousness' sake, you will be blessed. Have no fear of them, nor be troubled, **15**but in your hearts reverence Christ as Lord. Always be prepared to make a defense to any one who calls you to account for the hope that is in you, yet do it with gentleness and reverence; **16**and keep your conscience clear, so that, when you are abused, those who revile your good behavior in Christ may be put to shame. **17**For it is better to suffer for doing right, if that should be God's will, than for doing wrong.

18For Christ also died[h] for sins once for all, the righteous for the
unrighteous, that he might bring us to God, being put to death in the flesh
but made alive in the spirit; 19in which he went and preached to the spirits
in prison, 20who formerly did not obey, when God's patience waited in the
days of Noah, during the building of the ark, in which a few, that is, eight
persons, were saved through water. 21Baptism, which corresponds to this,
now saves you, not as a removal of dirt from the body but as an appeal to
God for a clear conscience, through the resurrection of Jesus Christ, 22who
has gone into heaven and is at the right hand of God, with angels,
authorities, and powers subject to him.

Good Stewards of God's Grace

4 Since therefore Christ suffered in the flesh,[i] arm yourselves with the
same thought, for whoever has suffered in the flesh has ceased from sin, *
2so as to live for the rest of the time in the flesh no longer by human
passions but by the will of God. 3Let the time that is past suffice for doing
what the Gentiles like to do, living in licentiousness, passions, drunkenness,
revels, carousing, and lawless idolatry. 4They are surprised that you do not
now join them in the same wild debauchery, and they abuse you; 5but they
will give account to him who is ready to judge the living and the dead. 6For
this is why the gospel was preached even to the dead, that though judged in
the flesh like men, they might live in the spirit like God.

7 The end of all things is at hand; therefore keep sane and sober for your
prayers. 8Above all hold unfailing your love for one another, since love
covers a multitude of sins. 9Practice hospitality ungrudgingly to one
another. 10As each has received a gift, employ it for one another, as good
stewards of God's varied grace: 11whoever speaks, as one who utters oracles
of God; whoever renders service, as one who renders it by the strength
which God supplies; in order that in everything God may be glorified
through Jesus Christ. To him belong glory and dominion for ever and ever.
Amen.

Suffering as a Christian

12 Beloved, do not be surprised at the fiery ordeal which comes upon you
to prove you, as though something strange were happening to you. 13But
rejoice in so far as you share Christ's sufferings, that you may also rejoice
and be glad when his glory is revealed. 14If you are reproached for the name

of Christ, you are blessed, because the spirit of glory[j] and of God rests upon you. 15But let none of you suffer as a murderer, or a thief, or a wrongdoer, or a mischief-maker; 16yet if one suffers as a Christian, let him not be ashamed, but under that name let him glorify God. 17For the time has come for judgment to begin with the household of God; and if it begins with us, what will be the end of those who do not obey the gospel of God? 18And

"If the righteous man is scarcely saved,
where will the impious and sinner appear?"

19Therefore let those who suffer according to God's will do right and entrust their souls to a faithful Creator.

Tending the Flock of Christ

5 So I exhort the elders among you, as a fellow elder and a witness of the sufferings of Christ as well as a partaker in the glory that is to be revealed. 2Tend the flock of God that is your charge,[k] not by constraint but willingly,[l] not for shameful gain but eagerly, 3not as domineering over those in your charge but being examples to the flock. 4And when the chief Shepherd is manifested you will obtain the unfading crown of glory. 5Likewise you that are younger be subject to the elders. Clothe yourselves, all of you, with humility toward one another, for "God opposes the proud, but gives grace to the humble."

6 Humble yourselves therefore under the mighty hand of God, that in due time he may exalt you. 7Cast all your anxieties on him, for he cares about you. 8Be sober, be watchful. Your adversary the devil prowls around like a roaring lion, seeking some one to devour. 9Resist him, firm in your faith, knowing that the same experience of suffering is required of your brotherhood throughout the world. 10And after you have suffered a little while, the God of all grace, who has called you to his eternal glory in Christ, will himself restore, establish, and strengthen[m] you. 11To him be the dominion for ever and ever. Amen.

Final Greetings and Benediction

12 By Silva'nus, a faithful brother as I regard him, I have written briefly to you, exhorting and declaring that this is the true grace of God; stand fast in it. 13She who is at Babylon, * who is likewise chosen, sends you greetings; and so does my son Mark. 14Greet one another with the kiss of love.

Peace to all of you that are in Christ.

2 Peter

Chapters

1 2 3

THE SECOND LETTER OF PETER

Salutation

1 Simon Peter, a servant and apostle of Jesus Christ,

To those who have obtained a faith of equal standing with ours in the righteousness of our God and Savior Jesus Christ:[a]

2 May grace and peace be multiplied to you in the knowledge of God and of Jesus our Lord.

The Christian's Call and Election

3 His divine power has granted to us all things that pertain to life and godliness, through the knowledge of him who called us to[b] his own glory and excellence, **4**by which he has granted to us his precious and very great promises, that through these you may escape from the corruption that is in the world because of passion, and become partakers of the divine nature. * **5**For this very reason make every effort to supplement your faith with virtue, and virtue with knowledge, **6**and knowledge with self-control, and self-control with steadfastness, and steadfastness with godliness, **7**and godliness with brotherly affection, and brotherly affection with love. **8**For if these things are yours and abound, they keep you from being ineffective or unfruitful in the knowledge of our Lord Jesus Christ. **9**For whoever lacks these things is blind and shortsighted and has forgotten that he was cleansed from his old sins. **10**Therefore, brethren, be the more zealous to confirm your call and election, for if you do this you will never fall; **11**so there will be richly provided for you an entrance into the eternal kingdom of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ.

12 Therefore I intend always to remind you of these things, though you know them and are established in the truth that you have. **13**I think it right, as long as I am in this body,[c] to arouse you by way of reminder, **14**since I know that the putting off of my body[c] will be soon, as our Lord Jesus Christ showed me. **15**And I will see to it that after my departure you may be able at any time to recall these things.

Eyewitnesses of Christ's Glory

16 * For we did not follow cleverly devised myths when we made known to you the power and coming of our Lord Jesus Christ, but we were eyewitnesses of his majesty. **17**For when he received honor and glory from God the Father and the voice was borne to him by the Majestic Glory, "This

is my beloved Son,[d] with whom I am well pleased," [18]we heard this voice borne from heaven, for we were with him on the holy mountain. [19]And we have the prophetic word made more sure. You will do well to pay attention to this as to a lamp shining in a dark place, until the day dawns and the morning star rises in your hearts. [20]First of all you must understand this, that no prophecy of Scripture is a matter of one's own interpretation, [21]because no prophecy ever came by the impulse of man, but men moved by the Holy Spirit spoke from God.[e]

False Prophets and Their Punishment

2 But false prophets also arose among the people, just as there will be false teachers among you, who will secretly bring in destructive heresies, even denying the Master who bought them, bringing upon themselves swift destruction. [2]And many will follow their licentiousness, and because of them the way of truth will be reviled. [3]And in their greed they will exploit you with false words; from of old their condemnation has not been idle, and their destruction has not been asleep. *

4 For if God did not spare the angels when they sinned, but cast them into hell[f] and committed them to pits of deepest darkness to be kept until the judgment; [5]if he did not spare the ancient world, but preserved Noah, a herald of righteousness, with seven other persons, when he brought a flood upon the world of the ungodly; [6]if by turning the cities of Sodom and Gomor'rah to ashes he condemned them to extinction and made them an example to those who were to be ungodly; [7]and if he rescued righteous Lot, greatly distressed by the licentiousness of the wicked [8](for by what that righteous man saw and heard as he lived among them, he was vexed in his righteous soul day after day with their lawless deeds), [9]then the Lord knows how to rescue the godly from trial, and to keep the unrighteous under punishment until the day of judgment, [10]and especially those who indulge in the lust of defiling passion and despise authority.

Bold and wilful, they are not afraid to revile the glorious ones, [11]whereas angels, though greater in might and power, do not pronounce a reviling judgment upon them before the Lord. [12]But these, like irrational animals, creatures of instinct, born to be caught and killed, reviling in matters of which they are ignorant, will be destroyed in the same destruction with them, [13]suffering wrong for their wrongdoing. They count it pleasure to

revel in the daytime. They are blots and blemishes, reveling in their dissipation,[g] carousing with you. 14They have eyes full of adultery,
insatiable for sin. They entice unsteady souls. They have hearts trained in
greed. Accursed children! 15Forsaking the right way they have gone astray;
they have followed the way of Balaam, the son of Beor, who loved gain
from wrongdoing, 16but was rebuked for his own transgression; a
speechless donkey spoke with human voice and restrained the prophet's
madness.

17 These are waterless springs and mists driven by a storm; for them the
deepest gloom of darkness has been reserved. 18For, uttering loud boasts of
folly, they entice with licentious passions of the flesh men who have barely
escaped from those who live in error. 19They promise them freedom, but
they themselves are slaves of corruption; for whatever overcomes a man, to
that he is enslaved. 20For if, after they have escaped the defilements of the
world through the knowledge of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ, they are
again entangled in them and overpowered, the last state has become worse
for them than the first. 21For it would have been better for them never to
have known the way of righteousness than after knowing it to turn back
from the holy commandment delivered to them. 22It has happened to them
according to the true proverb, The dog turns back to his own vomit, and the
sow is washed only to wallow in the mire.

The Promise of the Lord's Coming

3 This is now the second letter that I have written to you, beloved, and
in both of them I have aroused your sincere mind by way of reminder; 2that
you should remember the predictions of the holy prophets and the
commandment of the Lord and Savior through your apostles. 3First of all
you must understand this, that scoffers will come in the last days with
scoffing, following their own passions 4and saying, "Where is the promise
of his coming? For ever since the fathers fell asleep, all things have
continued as they were from the beginning of creation." 5They deliberately
ignore this fact, that by the word of God heavens existed long ago, and an
earth formed out of water and by means of water, 6through which the world
that then existed was deluged with water and perished. 7But by the same
word the heavens and earth that now exist have been stored up for fire,
being kept until the day of judgment and destruction of ungodly men.

8 But do not ignore this one fact, beloved, that with the Lord one day is as
a thousand years, and a thousand years as one day. 9The Lord is not slow
about his promise as some count slowness, but is forbearing toward you,[h]
not wishing that any should perish, but that all should reach repentance.
10But the day of the Lord will come like a thief, and then the heavens will
pass away with a loud noise, and the elements will be dissolved with fire,
and the earth and the works that are upon it will be burned up.
11 Since all these things are thus to be dissolved, what sort of persons
ought you to be in lives of holiness and godliness, 12waiting for and
hastening[i] the coming of the day of God, because of which the heavens will
be kindled and dissolved, and the elements will melt with fire! 13But
according to his promise we wait for new heavens and a new earth in which
righteousness dwells.

Final Exhortation and Doxology

14 Therefore, beloved, since you wait for these, be zealous to be found by
him without spot or blemish, and at peace. 15And count the forbearance of
our Lord as salvation. So also our beloved brother Paul wrote to you
according to the wisdom given him, 16speaking of this * as he does in all his
letters. There are some things in them hard to understand, which the
ignorant and unstable twist to their own destruction, as they do the other
Scriptures. 17You therefore, beloved, knowing this beforehand, beware lest
you be carried away with the error of lawless men and lose your own
stability. 18But grow in the grace and knowledge of our Lord and Savior
Jesus Christ. To him be the glory both now and to the day of eternity.
Amen.

1 John

Chapters

1 2 3 4 5

THE FIRST LETTER OF JOHN

The Word of Life

1 * That which was from the beginning, which we have heard, which we
have seen with our eyes, which we have looked upon and touched with our
hands, concerning the word of life—2the life was made manifest, and we
saw it, and testify to it, and proclaim to you the eternal life which was with
the Father and was made manifest to us—3that which we have seen and
heard we proclaim also to you, so that you may have fellowship * with us;
and our fellowship is with the Father and with his Son Jesus Christ. 4And
we are writing this that our[a] joy may be complete.

God Is Light

5 This is the message we have heard from him and proclaim to you, that
God is light and in him is no darkness * at all. 6If we say we have
fellowship with him while we walk in darkness, we lie and do not live
according to the truth; 7but if we walk in the light, as he is in the light, we
have fellowship with one another, and the blood of Jesus his Son cleanses
us from all sin. 8If we say we have no sin, we deceive ourselves, and the
truth is not in us. 9If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just, and will
forgive our sins and cleanse us from all unrighteousness. 10If we say we
have not sinned, we make him a liar, and his word is not in us.

Christ Is Our Advocate

2 My little children, I am writing this to you so that you may not sin; but
if any one does sin, we have an advocate with the Father, Jesus Christ the
righteous; 2and he is the expiation for our sins, and not for ours only but
also for the sins of the whole world. 3And by this we may be sure that we
know him, if we keep his commandments. * 4He who says “I know him”
but disobeys his commandments is a liar, and the truth is not in him; 5but
whoever keeps his word, in him truly love for God is perfected. By this we
may be sure that we are in him: 6he who says he abides in him ought to
walk in the same way in which he walked.

A New Commandment

7 Beloved, I am writing you no new commandment, but an old
commandment which you had from the beginning; the old commandment is
the word which you have heard. 8Yet I am writing you a new
commandment, which is true in him and in you, because[b] the darkness is

passing away and the true light is already shining. [9]He who says he is in the light and hates his brother is in the darkness still. [10]He who loves his brother abides in the light, and in it[c] there is no cause for stumbling. [11]But he who hates his brother is in the darkness and walks in the darkness, and does not know where he is going, because the darkness has blinded his eyes.

12 I am writing to you, little children, because your sins are forgiven for his sake. [13]I am writing to you, fathers, because you know him who is from the beginning. I am writing to you, young men, because you have overcome the Evil One. I write to you, children, because you know the Father. [14]I write to you, fathers, because you know him who is from the beginning. I write to you, young men, because you are strong, and the word of God abides in you, and you have overcome the Evil One.

15 Do not love the world or the things in the world. If any one loves the world, love for the Father is not in him. [16]For all that is in the world, the lust of the flesh and the lust of the eyes and the pride of life, is not of the Father but is of the world. [17]And the world passes away, and the lust of it; but he who does the will of God abides for ever.

Warning against the Antichrist

18 Children, it is the last hour; * and as you have heard that antichrist is coming, so now many antichrists have come; therefore we know that it is the last hour. [19]They went out from us, but they were not of us; for if they had been of us, they would have continued with us; but they went out, that it might be plain that they all are not of us. [20]But you have been anointed by the Holy One, and you all know.[d] [21]I write to you, not because you do not know the truth, but because you know it, and know that no lie is of the truth. [22]Who is the liar but he who denies that Jesus is the Christ? This is the antichrist, he who denies the Father and the Son. [23]Any one who denies the Son does not have the Father. He who confesses the Son has the Father also. [24]Let what you heard from the beginning abide in you. If what you heard from the beginning abides in you, then you will abide in the Son and in the Father. [25]And this is what he has promised us,[e] eternal life.

26 I write this to you about those who would deceive you; [27]but the anointing which you received from him abides in you, and you have no need that any one should teach you; as his anointing teaches you about everything, and is true, and is no lie, just as it has taught you, abide in him.

Children of God

28 And now, little children, abide in him, so that when he appears we may
have confidence and not shrink from him in shame at his coming. 29If you
know that he is righteous, you may be sure that every one who does right is
born of him.

3 See what love the Father has given us, that we should be called
children of God; and so we are. The reason why the world does not know us
is that it did not know him. 2Beloved, we are God's children now; it does
not yet appear what we shall be, but we know that when he appears we shall
be like him, for we shall see him as he is. 3And every one who thus hopes in
him purifies himself as he is pure.

4 Every one who commits sin is guilty of lawlessness; sin is lawlessness.
5You know that he appeared to take away sins, and in him there is no sin.
6Any one who abides in him does not sin; * any one who sins has not seen
him, nor has he known him. 7Little children, let no one deceive you. He
who does right is righteous, as he is righteous. 8He who commits sin is of
the devil; for the devil has sinned from the beginning. The reason the Son of
God appeared was to destroy the works of the devil. 9Any one born of God
does not commit sin; for God's[f] seed abides in him, and he cannot sin
because he is[g] born of God. 10By this it may be seen who are the children of
God, and who are the children of the devil: whoever does not do right is not
of God, nor he who does not love his brother.

Love One Another

11 For this is the message which you have heard from the beginning, that
we should love one another, 12and not be like Cain who was of the Evil One
and murdered his brother. And why did he murder him? Because his own
deeds were evil and his brother's righteous. 13Do not wonder, brethren, that
the world hates you. 14We know that we have passed out of death into life,
because we love the brethren. He who does not love remains in death.
15Any one who hates his brother is a murderer, and you know that no
murderer has eternal life abiding in him. 16By this we know love, that he
laid down his life for us; and we ought to lay down our lives for the
brethren. 17But if any one has the world's goods and sees his brother in
need, yet closes his heart against him, how does God's love abide in him?
18Little children, let us not love in word or speech but in deed and in truth.

19 By this we shall know that we are of the truth, and reassure our hearts
before him **20**whenever our hearts condemn us; for God is greater than our
hearts, and he knows everything. **21**Beloved, if our hearts do not condemn
us, we have confidence before God; **22**and we receive from him whatever
we ask, because we keep his commandments and do what pleases him.
23And this is his commandment, that we should believe in the name of his
Son Jesus Christ and love one another, just as he has commanded us. **24**All
who keep his commandments abide in him, and he in them. And by this we
know that he abides in us, by the Spirit which he has given us.

Testing the Spirits

4 Beloved, do not believe every spirit, but test the spirits * to see
whether they are of God; for many false prophets have gone out into the
world. **2**By this you know the Spirit of God: every spirit which confesses
that Jesus Christ has come in the flesh is of God, **3**and every spirit which
does not confess Jesus is not of God. This is the spirit of antichrist, of which
you heard that it was coming, and now it is in the world already. **4**Little
children, you are of God, and have overcome them; for he who is in you is
greater than he who is in the world. **5**They are of the world, therefore what
they say is of the world, and the world listens to them. **6**We are of God.
Whoever knows God listens to us, and he who is not of God does not listen
to us. By this we know the spirit of truth and the spirit of error.

God Is Love

7 Beloved, let us love one another; for love is of God, and he who loves is
born of God and knows God. **8**He who does not love does not know God;
for God is love. **9**In this the love of God was made manifest among us, that
God sent his only-begotten Son into the world, so that we might live
through him. **10**In this is love, not that we loved God but that he loved us
and sent his Son to be the expiation for our sins. **11**Beloved, if God so loved
us, we also ought to love one another. **12**No man has ever seen God; if we
love one another, God abides in us and his love is perfected in us.

13 By this we know that we abide in him and he in us, because he has
given us of his own Spirit. **14**And we have seen and testify that the Father
has sent his Son as the Savior of the world. **15**Whoever confesses that Jesus
is the Son of God, God abides in him, and he in God. **16**So we know and
believe the love God has for us. God is love, and he who abides in love

abides in God, and God abides in him. [17]In this is love perfected with us,
that we may have confidence for the day of judgment, because as he is so
are we in this world. [18]There is no fear in love, but perfect love casts out
fear. For fear has to do with punishment, and he who fears is not perfected
in love. [19]We love, because he first loved us. [20]If any one says, "I love
God," and hates his brother, he is a liar; for he who does not love his
brother whom he has seen, cannot[h] love God whom he has not seen. [21]And
this commandment we have from him, that he who loves God should love
his brother also.

Faith Conquers the World

5 Every one who believes that Jesus is the Christ has been born of God,
and every one who loves the parent loves the one begotten by him. [2]By this
we know that we love the children of God, when we love God and obey his
commandments. [3]For this is the love of God, that we keep his
commandments. And his commandments are not burdensome. [4]For
whatever is born of God overcomes the world; and this is the victory that
overcomes the world, our faith. [5]Who is it that overcomes the world but he
who believes that Jesus is the Son of God?

Testimony concerning the Son of God

6 This is he who came by water and blood, Jesus Christ, not with the
water only but with the water and the blood. [7]And the Spirit is the witness,
because the Spirit is the truth. [8]There are three witnesses, the Spirit, the
water, and the blood; and these three agree. * [9]If we receive the testimony
of men, the testimony of God is greater; for this is the testimony of God that
he has borne witness to his Son. [10]He who believes in the Son of God has
the testimony in himself. He who does not believe God has made him a liar,
because he has not believed in the testimony that God has borne to his Son.
[11]And this is the testimony, that God gave us eternal life, and this life is in
his Son. [12]He who has the Son has life; he who has not the Son of God has
not life.

Epilogue

13 I write this to you who believe in the name of the Son of God, that you
may know that you have eternal life. [14]And this is the confidence which we
have in him, that if we ask anything according to his will he hears us. [15]And
if we know that he hears us in whatever we ask, we know that we have

obtained the requests made of him. **16**If any one sees his brother committing what is not a deadly sin, he will ask, and God[i] will give him life for those whose sin is not deadly. There is sin which is deadly; I do not say that one is to pray for that. **17**All wrongdoing is sin, but there is sin which is not deadly.

18 We know that any one born of God does not sin, but He who was born of God keeps him, and the Evil One does not touch him.

19 We know that we are of God, and the whole world is in the power of the Evil One.

20 And we know that the Son of God has come and has given us understanding, to know him who is true; and we are in him who is true, in his Son Jesus Christ. This is the true God and eternal life. **21**Little children, keep yourselves from idols.

THE SECOND LETTER OF JOHN

Salutation

1 The elder * to the elect lady * and her children, whom I love in the truth,
and not only I but also all who know the truth, 2because of the truth which
abides in us and will be with us for ever:
3 Grace, mercy, and peace will be with us, from God the Father and from
Jesus Christ the Father's Son, in truth and love.

Truth and Love

4 I rejoiced greatly to find some of your children following the truth, just
as we have been commanded by the Father. 5And now I beg you, lady, not
as though I were writing you a new commandment, but the one we have had
from the beginning, that we love one another. 6And this is love, that we
follow his commandments; this is the commandment, as you have heard
from the beginning, that you follow love. 7For many deceivers have gone
out into the world, men who will not acknowledge the coming of Jesus
Christ in the flesh; such a one is the deceiver and the antichrist. 8Look to
yourselves, that you may not lose what you[a] have worked for, but may win
a full reward. 9Any one who goes ahead and does not abide in the doctrine
of Christ does not have God; he who abides in the doctrine has both the
Father and the Son. 10If any one comes to you and does not bring this
doctrine, do not receive him into the house or give him any greeting; 11for
he who greets him shares his wicked work.

Final Greetings

12 Though I have much to write to you, I would rather not use paper and
ink, but I hope to come to see you and talk with you face to face, so that our
joy may be complete.
13 The children * of your elect sister greet you.

THE THIRD LETTER OF JOHN

Salutation

1 The elder to the beloved Ga'ius, whom I love in the truth.

Gaius Commended for His Service

2 Beloved, I pray that all may go well with you and that you may be in
health; I know that it is well with your soul. 3For I greatly rejoiced when
some of the brethren arrived and testified to the truth of your life, as indeed
you do follow the truth. 4No greater joy can I have than this, to hear that my
children follow the truth.

5 Beloved, it is a loyal thing you do when you render any service to the
brethren, especially to strangers, 6who have testified to your love before the
Church. You will do well to send them on their journey as befits God's
service. 7For they have set out for his sake and have accepted nothing from
the heathen. 8So we ought to support such men, that we may be fellow
workers in the truth.

Diotrephes and Demetrius

9 I have written something to the Church; but Diot'rephes, who likes to
put himself first, does not acknowledge my authority. 10So if I come, I will
bring up what he is doing, accusing me falsely with evil words. And not
content with that, he refuses himself to welcome the brethren, and also
stops those who want to welcome them and puts them out of the Church.

11 Beloved, do not imitate evil but imitate good. He who does good is of
God; he who does evil has not seen God. 12Deme'trius * has testimony from
every one, and from the truth itself; I testify to him too, and you know my
testimony is true.

Final Greetings

13 I had much to write to you, but I would rather not write with pen and
ink; 14I hope to see you soon, and we will talk together face to face.

15 Peace be to you. The friends greet you. Greet the friends, every one of
them.

THE LETTER OF JUDE

Salutation

1 Jude, a servant of Jesus Christ and brother of James,

To those who are called, beloved in God the Father and kept for Jesus Christ:

2 May mercy, peace, and love be multiplied to you.

Occasion of the Letter

3 Beloved, being very eager to write to you of our common salvation, I found it necessary to write appealing to you to contend for the faith which was once for all delivered to the saints. **4**For admission has been secretly gained by some who long ago were designated for this condemnation, ungodly persons who pervert the grace of our God into licentiousness and deny our only Master and Lord, Jesus Christ.[a]

Judgment on the Ungodly

5 Now I desire to remind you, though you were once for all fully informed, that he[b] who saved a people out of the land of Egypt, afterward destroyed those who did not believe. **6**And the angels that did not keep their own position but left their proper dwelling have been kept by him in eternal chains in the deepest darkness until the judgment of the great day; * **7**just as Sodom and Gomor'rah and the surrounding cities, which likewise acted immorally and indulged in unnatural lust, serve as an example by undergoing a punishment of eternal fire.

8 Yet in like manner these men in their dreamings defile the flesh, reject authority, and revile the glorious ones.[c] **9**But when the archangel Michael, contending with the devil, disputed about the body of Moses, he did not presume to pronounce a reviling judgment upon him, but said, “The Lord rebuke you.” * **10**But these men revile whatever they do not understand, and by those things that they know by instinct as irrational animals do, they are destroyed. **11**Woe to them! For they walk in the way of Cain, and abandon themselves for the sake of gain to Balaam’s error, and perish in Ko'rah’s rebellion. **12**These are blemishes[d] on your love feasts, as they boldly carouse together, looking after themselves; waterless clouds, carried along by winds; fruitless trees in late autumn, twice dead, uprooted; **13**wild waves of the sea, casting up the foam of their own shame; wandering stars for whom the deepest darkness has been reserved for ever.

14 It was of these also that Enoch in the seventh generation from Adam
prophesied, saying, “Behold, the Lord came with myriads of his holy ones,
15to execute judgment on all, and to convict all the ungodly of all their
deeds of ungodliness which they have committed in such an ungodly way,
and of all the harsh things which ungodly sinners have spoken against him.”
16These are grumblers, malcontents, following their own passions, loud-
mouthed boasters, flattering people to gain advantage.

Warnings and Exhortations

17 But you must remember, beloved, the predictions of the apostles of our
Lord Jesus Christ; 18they said to you, “In the last time there will be scoffers,
following their own ungodly passions.” 19It is these who set up divisions,
worldly people, devoid of the Spirit. 20But you, beloved, build yourselves
up on your most holy faith; pray in the Holy Spirit; 21keep yourselves in the
love of God; wait for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ unto eternal life.
22And convince some, who doubt; 23save some, by snatching them out of
the fire; on some have mercy with fear, hating even the garment spotted by
the flesh.[e]

Benediction

24 Now to him who is able to keep you from falling and to present you
without blemish before the presence of his glory with rejoicing, 25to the
only God, our Savior through Jesus Christ our Lord, be glory, majesty,
dominion, and authority, before all time and now and for ever. Amen.